

Trial run — break it before a client can



CF Building Approvals — internal. Staff missions for testing the client portal.

August 2026 · Live system — real cards, real emails · Allow 45–60 minutes each, spread over a week

You each get a pretend building company and a set of missions. Work them as a real client would — on your own machine, some of it on your phone — and report everything that's confusing, wrong, slow or broken. Finding it now costs nothing; a client finding it costs trust.

This is the live system. Every lodgement creates a real card on the board and sends real emails. Put **TEST** in *Your Reference* and in the *Notes for CFBA* box on every job, so nothing gets assessed by accident — and the office deletes the cards when we're done.

SETUP — THE OFFICE DOES THIS FIRST (TEN MINUTES)

- ✓ **One test client per tester** — /admin → Clients → *Add a client*, named `ZZZ Test – [First name]` (the ZZZ keeps them together and makes the cleanup sweep obvious). Email It To fills with the login email automatically.
- ✓ **Issue each tester a login** to their own work email — they walk the same first-sign-in a client does, guide attached to the email and all.
- ✓ **Turn the review queue on for the trial:** in Vercel set `AUTO_ACCEPT_LODGEMENTS=0` and redeploy. Lodgements then wait in /admin for a human Accept/Reject — which is the only way to test rejections. Flip it back after the trial.
- ✓ **Pick addresses before you start:** each tester wants one address they know is **bushfire prone** and one that isn't — use real lots from recent jobs; the form checks the real DFES map as you type.

HOW TO REPORT WHAT YOU FIND

- ✓ **Send feedback** — bottom of the portal menu, on every page. Pick *Confusing / Slow / Broken / Idea*, one blunt line is plenty. It captures which page and job you were on, so report from the spot where it happened.
- ✓ Everything lands on /admin → **Feedback** with the weekly counts — that page is the trial's scoreboard.
- ✓ Something stops you dead? Ring Chris. Don't work around it quietly — the workaround is the finding.

EVERYONE, FIRST (TEN MINUTES — BEFORE YOUR MISSIONS)

- ✓ First sign-in from the login email: setup code → choose a password. Does the email and its attached guide make sense on their own?
- ✓ Sign out. Get your password **wrong four times on purpose** — the message should turn into a polite lockout with a wait and the office number, not a dead end. Use *Forgot password?* to finish.
- ✓ Open the portal on your **phone** and click through the menu. Half our clients will only ever see it this way.

Bushfire — the shed paths

TESTER A

- ✓ Lodge a **steel shed** at your bushfire-prone address. Within 6 m of the house + house **2016 or later** → it must demand the shed's own new BAL report and refuse to lodge without it.
- ✓ Flip the answer to **before 2016** → the demand should vanish: exempt, lodge freely. Flip to **Not sure** → it lodges, noting we'll confirm.
- ✓ Say the shed is **6 m or more away** → no BAL anything.
- ✓ Same shed at your **non-prone address** → no bushfire questions at all.

Bushfire (patio) + strata

TESTER B

- ✓ Patio at the prone address, within 6 m, house 2016+ → it should ask the house's rating (pick one) and require the **evidence** upload. Office: check the card's BAL column got stamped with what was picked.
- ✓ The strata question is **compulsory**: fill everything else in and leave it unanswered — the Lodge button must stay locked and say why.
- ✓ Answer **Yes** → a required Strata Plan box appears after Engineering; try to lodge without it (locked, named), then attach and lodge.

Files — try to make a mess

TESTER C

- ✓ Attach a Word doc or photo → it must be **named and refused out loud**, never silently dropped.
- ✓ Two PDFs with the **same filename** → the second gets a **-2**, nothing overwritten.
- ✓ Something over **40 MB** → refused with the email-the-office path.
- ✓ Ugly filenames — dashes, brackets, percent signs, very long — all accepted.
- ✓ Check the *"Filed as..."* line, then confirm the card carries exactly those tidy site-named PDFs. **Double-click** Lodge — exactly one card.
- ✓ Slip a certificate of title or BA1 into the pile — the portal leaves them out on purpose (we never need them).

Documents, reuse, speed

TESTER D

- ✓ Lodging, tick **Save this engineering to My Documents** and name it.
- ✓ Second job: tick it under **From Your Documents** instead of uploading — the Engineering requirement should count as met.
- ✓ **My Documents** page: replace the file, then delete it.
- ✓ Open a finished job → **Lodge Similar** — everything but the address carries across.
- ✓ My Details → **Team**: issue a second login for yourself, then disable it — the disabled one must not get in.

TOOLS — ONE PASS EACH, ANY TESTER

- ✓ Wind classification — a real site in, sensible class out
- ✓ Soakwell calculator — a real roof area
- ✓ Bushfire map check under Tools — same verdict as the lodgement form gave you
- ✓ Site plan tool — draw one simple lot
- ✓ Info Sheets — open two notes; do they load and read cleanly on the phone?
- ✓ Public status checker — a test ref + address, watching it move

EVERYONE, DURING THE WEEK — THE ROUND TRIPS (OFFICE PLAYS ITS HALF)

Information request	Office: set a test card to FIR with a <code>FIR:</code> note. Tester: the email arrives with the ask written out; reply on the job with a PDF → the banner flips to <i>Answer sent — it's with us</i> and the office gets the reply email. Office: reword the ask on the card → the amber "with you" state comes back.
Rejection	Office: reject one queued lodgement with a written reason . Tester: the dashboard shows that reason word for word, with <i>Lodge It Again</i> .
Cancellation	Tester: request a cancel from the job page. Office: the card gets <code>CANCELLATION REQUESTED</code> + an email; move the card to Cancelled. Tester: the job files under Past as Cancelled.
Issue & download	Office: drive one test job all the way — ref, folder, assess, CDC, Issued. Tester: the ready email arrives; download the package, open every file; the page says certificates stay downloadable for 3 months and we keep a copy.
Amendment	Tester: lodge an amendment against that issued job. Office: it emails whoever certified it, shows <code>WAITING</code> under <code>/admin</code> → Amendments; upload a revised certificate. Tester: both certificates sit side by side in Downloads.
Enquiry	Tester: My Messages → the general thread — subject + a question. Office: answer from <code>/admin</code> → Enquiries. Tester: the reply lands in the portal and your inbox.

WHILE YOU'RE IN THERE — THE THINGS WORTH NOTICING

- ✓ At every step, is it obvious **whose move it is** — yours or ours? That's the whole design; anywhere it isn't obvious is a finding.
- ✓ Does the wording sound like us on the phone, or like a computer?
- ✓ Anything you had to read twice, tap twice, or scroll sideways for — especially on the phone.
- ✓ After each lodgement, answer the little **portal or email?** question honestly — it's the pilot's core measure and it only appears once a fortnight.
- ✓ Send at least one piece of feedback with **"Okay to ring me"** ticked, so we see that path too.

THE SCOREBOARD, DAILY

Whoever's running the trial keeps `/admin` → **Feedback** open: the weekly counts (lodgements started vs completed, refused uploads, downloads, sign-ins, feedback) should move as the missions run — if a number doesn't move when it should, that's a finding too. The pre-flight card at the top of `/admin` stays green throughout.

CLEANUP — BEFORE ANY REAL CLIENT IS INVITED

- Delete every test card from the board (search the `TEST` reference).
- `/admin` → Clients: delete each `ZZZ Test` company — logins, jobs and messages cascade with it.
- Set `AUTO_ACCEPT_LODGEMENTS` back (remove the 0) and redeploy.
- Run the data-hygiene sweep in the go-live runbook (Phase 7) so the store and the pilot dials start clean.
- One last look at `/admin` → Feedback: collect the findings into a list, fix or accept each one out loud, and only then send the first invitation.

The bar: a tester who hits a dead end, a silent failure, or a "what do I do now?" moment has found something a paying client would have found next week. That's the win — say it loudly, fix it quietly.